

big negative gears in motion. That is why success of every kind depends on a positive point of view . . . within yourself and conveyed to others.

Enthusiasm is the one great emotion which automatically guarantees that your point of view will be positive!

Does that mean that you must never mention a negative matter, never admit you even know about illness, poverty, accidents, war? It does not mean this. We are well advised to keep negative trends out of our general conversation; to accentuate the positive, talk on the side we want to prevail. But reality is reality. Take it as it stands, when it is negative, and show a way out! Then your statement, to your own mind or to another's, carries *service*, points the way to a better life.

Perhaps the best illustration is one of the simplest. An old advertising slogan, still going strong, is: *Got a headache? Take X aspirin.* The negative condition is admitted; the positive, happy way out is immediately shown. It was not aspirin—of which I used to take plenty—but peace of mind which finally rid me of headaches, so I forbear to name the aspirin makers—but I cannot think of a better negative-into-positive transformation than is carried in those six words. Note the principle: *Is something wrong? Here's how to make it right.*

Good selling is honest selling. I speak of selling in the sense of "selling" ideas which thereupon can be transmuted into reality.

I think back to that memorable moment when my new stepmother—whom I had been told to view with suspicion—took me under the chin and announced that Napoleon Hill was not a bad boy but a smart boy whose mind needed only to be guided. The honest conviction and tender enthusiasm of those words struck away all the falsehoods that had been fed into my young mind. From that moment on I looked for ways to improve myself; and when I looked, I found them.

Good selling is honest selling. *No person can afford to express, through thoughts or acts, that which is not in harmony with his own belief, for if he does he must pay by the loss of his ability to influence others.*

I know it is only when I speak from the heart that I can persuade an audience to accept my message.

At one time I might have reaped a considerable monetary advantage because I was known not to be allied with Big Business or with any political faction. I was approached by a representative of a Latin American government which the